

This section doesn't need to be included- it's wording for me in the future

Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)

- The student demonstrates developmental differences that affect communication, social interaction, and access to the educational environment.
- Characteristics associated with autism adversely impact the student's educational performance across settings.
- The student requires specially designed instruction and supports to address needs related to autism.
- The student is demonstrating deficits in his overall social interaction skills as evidenced from parent and teacher reports on the SRS-2 and ASRS rating scales, as well as from information provided in classroom observations and parent teacher report from previous evaluation.
- David demonstrates restricted and repetitive behaviors and interests. He engages in sensory-seeking behaviors and demonstrates highly specific and rigid interests. Results of the SRS-2 and ASRS parent and teacher forms show significantly elevated levels of restricted interests and repetitive behaviors.
- David's symptoms of an autism spectrum disorder does significantly and negatively impact his social skills, communication skills, behavior, and academic progress in the classroom.
- He has difficulty with social interactions with classmates, preferring to play by himself. He plays with other students when doing a preferred activity, such as computer game during indoor recess. He tends to gravitate toward his teachers. He does not often interact with his peers, but communicates with his teachers when he is irritated with his peers. He refuses to work in groups, doing work on his own.
- He is fixated on bugs and has a debilitating aversion to them. He struggles with fire drills due to bugs being outside and near him.

SOCIAL INTERACTION

"STUDENT NAME demonstrates pervasive atypical patterns in social interactions in the following areas: __, __, __"

- Difficulty initiating and/or maintaining conversations
- Reduced use or understanding of nonverbal communication
 - (e.g., eye contact, gestures)
- Challenges interpreting social cues or others' perspectives

- Limited reciprocal interaction with peers
- Reduced eye contact/gestures
- Limited initiation of social interactions with peers or adults
- Reduced response to social initiations
 - (e.g., does not respond when name is called, ignores greetings)
- Difficulty engaging in reciprocal conversations
 - (e.g., one-sided interactions, limited back-and-forth exchange)
- Difficulty understanding and using nonverbal communication
 - (e.g., facial expressions, gestures, body language)
- Limited interest in sharing enjoyment, interests, or achievements with others
- Difficulty developing and maintaining peer relationships
- Interactions may appear awkward, scripted, or overly formal
- Difficulty understanding social norms and expectations
 - (e.g., personal space, turn-taking)
- Limited awareness of others' perspectives, emotions, or social cues
- Approaches others in an unusual or inappropriate manner
- Limited imitation of peers' behaviors or social actions
- Reduced emotional reciprocity
 - (e.g., limited response to others' emotions)
- Difficulty interpreting tone of voice, sarcasm, or humor
- Engages in parallel play rather than interactive play
- Limited or inconsistent response to joint attention
 - (e.g., following a point, sharing focus on an object/event)
- Tendency to talk at others rather than with others
- Prefers interactions with adults over peers
- Prefers interactions with peers over adults

RESTRICTED AND REPETITIVE BEHAVIORS

“STUDENT NAME demonstrates pervasive atypical patterns in behaviors in the following areas: __, __, __”

- Highly focused or intense interests
- Need for predictability
- Strong interests in: _____
- Repetitive movements
 - (e.g., hand flapping, rocking)
- Repetitive speech
 - (e.g., scripting, echolalia, repeating phrases)

- sensitivity to environmental stimuli
- Repetitive use of objects
 - (e.g., lining up items, spinning objects, flipping items repeatedly)
- Insistence on sameness
- strict adherence to routines
- Distress or difficulty coping with changes in schedule, transitions, or unexpected events
- Rigid thinking patterns
 - (e.g., difficulty with flexibility, “all or nothing” thinking)
- Highly restricted or fixated interests that are abnormal in intensity or focus
- Strong preoccupation with specific topics, objects, or activities
- Difficulty shifting attention away from preferred interests
- Use of repetitive play themes or limited imaginative play
- Unusual attachment to objects
 - (e.g., carrying specific items, distress if unavailable)
- Ritualized patterns of behavior
 - (e.g., needing to complete tasks in a specific order)
- Resistance to trying new activities, foods, or experiences
- Sensory sensitivities
 - (e.g., over- or under-reactivity to sounds, textures, lights, smells)
- Seeking sensory input
 - (e.g., touching objects excessively, seeking movement)
- Unusual visual inspection of objects
 - (e.g., looking at items from specific angles, close to eyes)
- Difficulty transitioning away from preferred activities
- Repetitive body movements when excited, stressed, or overstimulated
- Fixation on parts of objects rather than whole
 - (e.g., wheels of a toy instead of the toy itself)
- Limited range of interests or activities
- Repetitive patterns in drawing, writing, or play
- Strong need for predictability and routine

COMMUNICATION

“STUDENT NAME demonstrates pervasive atypical patterns in communication in the following areas: ___, ___, ___”

- Delayed language development
- limited verbal communication
- Limited use of spoken language

- Limited initiation or maintenance of interactions
- Difficulty engaging in reciprocal conversation
- Tendency to use one-word responses or short phrases rather than expanded language
- Repetitive or scripted language
 - (e.g., echolalia, use of memorized phrases)
- Atypical tone, pitch, or volume of speech
 - (e.g., monotone, overly loud or quiet)
- Difficulty answering open-ended questions
- Difficulty staying on topic during conversation
- Tendency to talk excessively about preferred topics without regard to listener interest
- Limited ability to ask questions or seek clarification
- Difficulty interpreting and using nonverbal communication
 - (e.g., gestures, facial expressions)
- Reduced use of gestures to support communication
 - (e.g., pointing, nodding)
- Difficulty understanding figurative language
 - (e.g., idioms, sarcasm, humor)
- Literal interpretation of language
- Difficulty following multi-step verbal directions
- Challenges with receptive language
 - (e.g., understanding spoken information)
- Difficulty expressing wants, needs, or ideas clearly
- Limited ability to repair communication breakdowns
 - (e.g., does not rephrase when misunderstood)
- Difficulty engaging in imaginative or pretend play involving language
- Unusual phrasing or word use
- Uses language primarily for requests rather than for social interaction
- Difficulty adjusting communication based on context or audience
- Reduced joint attention
 - (e.g., difficulty sharing focus or commenting on shared experiences)

EDUCATIONAL IMPACT

“STUDENT NAME has difficulties in the following areas, which impact his educational performance: _____,”

- Executive functioning skills
 - (organization, planning, task initiation, and work completion)
- unexpected changes to schedule

- social skills
- sensory sensitivity
- functional communication
- Behavioral/self-regulation skills
- Flexibility and coping with unexpected changes or transitions
- coping strategies
- Social interaction
- peer engagement skills
- Communication skills
 - (expressive, receptive)
- Repetitive behaviors
- Sensory processing and regulation
- Behavioral and self-regulation skills
- Participation in group activities
- Participation in collaborative learning